

TechCorp Vendor Offboarding Policy

Data Deletion, Access Revocation & Exit Procedures

Version: v1.0

Document: TC-VOB-012

TechCorp Internal

1. Purpose & Scope

This policy defines TechCorp's procedures for safely and completely offboarding third-party vendors at the end of a contract relationship. It covers all steps required to revoke access, recover or delete data, settle final obligations, and document lessons learned — regardless of whether offboarding is planned or for cause.

Applies To	All departments offboarding any tier vendor (T1–T4)
Policy Owner	Head of Procurement & VP of Engineering
Review Cycle	Annual — or immediately following a material offboarding event
Effective	January 1, 2026
Document ID	TC-VOB-012 v1.0
Related Docs	TC-VMS-011 (Vendor Management & SLA Policy)

2. Offboarding Triggers

Vendor offboarding is initiated under any of the following circumstances:

Trigger	Description	Notice Required
Contract Non-renewal	Contract term ends and is not renewed	Per contract (30–90 days)
Termination for Convenience	TechCorp elects to exit without cause	90 days (T1), 30 days (T2/T3)
Termination for Cause	Vendor breaches SLA, security, or contract terms	Immediate or 30 days
Vendor Acquisition/Shutdown	Vendor is acquired, merged, or ceases operations	Expedited — 5 business days
Security Incident	Vendor involved in data breach or compliance failure	Immediate suspension
Product Consolidation	TechCorp migrates to an alternative solution	Per contract terms
Cost Optimization	Service no longer cost-justified after annual review	Per contract terms

3. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Procurement Lead	Initiates offboarding ticket; issues formal termination notice; manages final invoicing
Contract Owner (Dept)	Coordinates data export, confirms business continuity plan is in place
IT / Security	Revokes SSO, API keys, and all system access; confirms deprovisioning
Legal	Reviews termination clause compliance; retains contract records
Finance	Closes PO; settles final invoice; recovers pre-paid amounts if applicable
SRE / Infra	Removes vendor integrations, webhooks, and monitoring agents
Data / Privacy	Confirms data deletion certificate received and archived

4. Step-by-Step Offboarding Process

Phase 1 — Initiation

Step 1: Procurement creates Offboarding Ticket in Jira (template: VND-OFF)
Step 2: Offboarding ticket linked to original Vendor Registry entry
Step 3: Formal written termination notice sent to vendor (email + certified letter for T1)
Step 4: Notice period start date recorded; calendar reminders set for key milestones
Step 5: Internal stakeholders notified via Slack #vendor-offboarding channel

Phase 2 — Data Export & Recovery

Step 6: Data export request sent to vendor within 5 business days of notice
Step 7: Vendor must deliver complete data export within 15 business days
Step 8: Exported data validated for completeness by contract owner
Step 9: Data transferred to TechCorp-controlled storage (S3 or internal DB)
Step 10: Data export receipt confirmed in writing and attached to Jira ticket

Phase 3 — Access Revocation

Step 11: IT Security submits Access Revocation Checklist (template: SEC-REV)
Step 12: SSO / SAML integration disabled in Okta
Step 13: All API keys and OAuth tokens issued to vendor revoked
Step 14: Vendor user accounts removed from all TechCorp systems
Step 15: Webhooks, event subscriptions, and outbound integrations disabled
Step 16: Monitoring agents or SDKs removed from production infrastructure
Step 17: Network firewall rules updated to block vendor IP ranges (T1 only)
Step 18: Access revocation confirmed and signed off by Security Lead

Phase 4 — Data Deletion Confirmation

Step 19: Formal data deletion request sent to vendor upon contract end date
Step 20: Vendor must confirm deletion of all TechCorp data within 30 days
Step 21: Deletion confirmation received in writing (email or signed certificate)
Step 22: Deletion certificate archived in Legal Vault (Notion: Legal > Vendor Records)
Step 23: If vendor fails to confirm – escalate to Legal for formal demand letter

Phase 5 — Financial Closeout

Step 24: Finance reviews final invoice for accuracy against contract terms
Step 25: Pre-paid / unused credits recovered or credited where contractually entitled
Step 26: Any outstanding service credits (SLA breaches) applied before final payment
Step 27: PO closed in Finance ERP; payment settled within net-30 of final invoice
Step 28: Finance confirms zero outstanding obligations in writing

Phase 6 — Closeout & Documentation

Step 29: Vendor marked 'Offboarded' in Vendor Registry with offboarding date
Step 30: All contract documents archived in Legal Vault – retained for 7 years
Step 31: Lessons learned documented for T1/T2 vendors or for-cause offboardings
Step 32: Offboarding ticket closed; summary email sent to all stakeholders

5. Offboarding Timeline by Vendor Tier

Milestone	T1 Critical	T2 Important	T3/T4 Standard
Termination Notice	90 days prior	30 days prior	14 days prior
Data Export Request	Day 1 of notice	Day 1 of notice	Day 5 of notice
Data Export Received	Within 15 biz days	Within 15 biz days	Within 20 biz days
Access Revocation	Contract end date	Contract end date	Contract end date
Data Deletion Confirmation	Within 30 days	Within 30 days	Within 45 days
Financial Closeout	Within 30 days	Within 30 days	Within 45 days
Lessons Learned Doc	Required	Required	Optional
Record Retention	7 years	7 years	3 years

6. Emergency Offboarding Procedure

Emergency offboarding applies when a vendor poses an immediate security or compliance risk (e.g., confirmed data breach, insolvency, or hostile acquisition). Standard notice periods are waived.

- Decision to emergency offboard requires approval from VP Engineering + Security Officer
- Access revocation must be completed within 4 hours of decision

- Legal notified immediately to assess contract termination rights
- Data export request issued within 24 hours; vendor given 5 business days to comply
- If vendor is unresponsive, Legal issues formal data return demand within 48 hours
- Incident documented in Security incident log regardless of outcome
- Post-incident review completed within 10 business days

7. Data Handling After Offboarding

Data Recovered from Vendor	Validated, re-ingested into TechCorp systems, and tagged as vendor-origin
Data Not Recovered	Legal escalation within 30 days; GDPR breach assessment if PII involved
Duplicate Data	Deduplication run within 30 days of import into TechCorp storage
Sensitive / PII Data	DPO notified; data mapped and handled per TechCorp Data Retention Policy
Backup Tapes / Archives	Vendor must certify destruction of all backup copies in deletion certificate
Subprocessor Data	Vendor must cascade deletion requirement to any approved subprocessors
Retention of Vendor Data	TechCorp retains exported data per internal data retention schedules

8. Access Revocation Checklist

The IT Security team must complete and sign off every item below before the offboarding ticket can be closed.

#	Action Item	Owner	Done
1	Disable SSO/SAML app in Okta	IT	☐
2	Revoke all API keys in API Gateway / AWS IAM	IT/SRE	☐
3	Revoke OAuth tokens and refresh tokens	IT	☐
4	Remove vendor users from GitHub org	IT	☐
5	Remove vendor users from Jira / Confluence	IT	☐
6	Disable vendor Slack guest accounts	IT	☐
7	Remove webhooks and event subscriptions	SRE	☐
8	Remove monitoring/APM agents from infrastructure	SRE	☐
9	Update firewall / security group rules (T1 only)	SRE	☐
10	Remove vendor from secrets rotation schedule	Security	☐
11	Confirm zero active sessions in audit logs	Security	☐
12	Sign off complete — Security Lead signature + date	Security	☐

9. Lessons Learned & Continuous Improvement

For all T1/T2 offboardings and any offboarding triggered by cause, a Lessons Learned document must be completed within 10 business days of offboarding closure.

- Document template: Notion > Procurement > Vendor Offboarding > Lessons Learned
- Required sections: reason for offboarding, what went well, what could be improved, recommended vendor selection criteria changes
- Reviewed by Head of Procurement and circulated to relevant department heads
- Recurring issues identified across multiple offboardings are escalated to vendor policy review
- Annual aggregate report presented to VP Engineering summarizing all offboarding activity

10. Policy Exceptions

- Exceptions require written approval from VP Engineering and Head of Procurement
- No exception may waive the data deletion confirmation requirement for vendors handling PII
- No exception may extend the emergency access revocation window beyond 24 hours
- All exceptions logged in the Vendor Registry with justification, approver, and expiry
- Exceptions reviewed annually as part of the vendor policy review cycle